



6-13-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvGpEmBL6WM
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Document Type: Comprehensive Community & Policy Analysis Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer, Board President Mr. Williams.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Board President Mr. Williams, Dr. O'Neil, Miss Barnes Griffin, Mr. Urban, Mr. Wall.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Heater.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Disposition of prior meeting minutes was handled under the consent agenda.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:39:57 Consent Agenda Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Board President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed additions to the consent agenda, including staffing for elementary summer programs (specifically for the iRead 3 literacy camp across various locations such as EWA, NVE, WVGES, SVE) and a personnel transfer (Stacy Foltz transferring from a behavior coach at South Elementary to Southside Middle School). The board also briefly addressed a question regarding an agreement with "The Crossing," a faith-based alternative program used in multiple school districts across the state. Officials clarified that the program is entirely voluntary, at no cost to taxpayers, utilizes the old MAC facility on Elgin Avenue, and serves as an optional tool to keep at-risk students engaged who might otherwise drop out of public education.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Mr. Rick Answer expressed concerns regarding the partnership with The Crossing, questioning the integration of a faith-based group into public education and asking about potential costs to taxpayers. He also inquired about community reports regarding grade school graduation access and staff changes at South View.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:43:29 Financial Report (May Financial Results)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome reported that the district received its state basic grant for the month of May (\$3.4 million), with a projected total of over \$43.8 million for the calendar year. The overall checkbook/cash balance stands at over \$36.2 million, and all funds are projected to exceed \$34 million by the end of the calendar year. The education fund balance at the end of May was over \$15.7 million, and the rainy day fund remained strong at over \$10.5 million. Local property tax receipts have begun arriving.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:45:18 Permission to Advertise for Public Hearing for Future Capital Improvements (2024 Projects)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for permission to advertise for a public hearing for future capital improvements for 2024 projects, utilizing lease rental or general obligation bonds structured via Baker Tilly. The financing is designed with a short

(four-year) payback term to maintain a “tax neutral” provision with no increase on the tax rate. A public hearing will be held in two weeks.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:47:19 Middle School Science Textbook Adoption**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Eric Graham.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Graham presented the recommendation to adopt McGraw-Hill as the core middle school science textbook and instructional package (including hard copies, online materials, and lab material kits) for general education and honors classes for a six-year adoption cycle. The selection followed a review committee process involving sample reviews, a textbook caravan, vendor presentations, and a near-unanimous committee vote. The previous instructional kits through Purdue University are no longer in existence.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **05:41:15 Calendar Revisions (2023<U+2013>2024 School Year Adjustments)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds presented calendar revisions derived from staff and family feedback regarding the challenges of synchronous e-learning days. The adjustments embed three snow makeup days at the end of the academic year (extending the school year past Memorial Day to May 29 regardless of inclement weather) and designate specific Fridays (April 12, April 26, and May 10) as potential days off unless needed for snow makeup. Additionally, one early release day is shifted to April 8 to accommodate community participation in the solar eclipse.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:59:06 Student and Family Handbook and Support Guide Revisions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds and Committee Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds presented a comprehensive overhaul of the student handbook, developed collaboratively since January with a committee, student advisory input, and consultation from Ball State University school psychology expert Dr. Janae Sanders. Key updates shift away from punitive measures (such as removing certain driver’s license revocation clauses, excessive truancy penalties, and restrictive language) toward a more restorative, supportive approach emphasizing student support teams, clearer attendance and tardiness practices, updated dress code language (including student-informed revisions), and the official removal of textbook fees in compliance with new legislation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:17:37 Public Hearings & Resolutions: 2023 Building Project Bonds (Muncie Central High School Stadium / Phase 2)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome and Board President.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board conducted statutory public hearings for Phase 2 of the Muncie Central High School building project (totaling \$6.1 million for a 7,000-square-foot North End Zone facility featuring restrooms, locker rooms, storage, coaches' offices, and south-end restrooms). The project is structured with a two-year payback (2024<U+2013>2025) under a tax-neutral provision using 2023 bonds issued via the Muncie Multi-School Building Corporation (lessors: Ronnie Johnson, John Mull, and Cornelius Donaldson).
 - *Hearing 1:* Lease Agreement between the School Corporation and Building Corporation.
 - *Hearing 2:* Additional Appropriation Resolution.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Mr. Rick Answer* questioned the use of building corporations and inquired about general contractor bidding practices and local labor usage.
 - *Mr. Jeff Star (Star Financial Bank)* followed up on the bond marketplace timeline, noting that bids/sales are anticipated in the fall (September/October).
 - *Mr. Rick Answer* spoke a second time, questioning the necessity of debt issuance given existing cash reserves. Mr. Jerome and board members clarified statutory distinctions restricting education fund balances from being utilized for capital facility projects.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Lease Resolution (**Exhibit A**): Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Additional Appropriation Resolution (**Exhibit B**): Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Resolution Assigning Construction Bids and Contracts (**Exhibit C**): Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Master Continuing Disclosure Undertaking Resolution (**Exhibit D**): Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Motion to adjourn hearings: Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:37:43 Mr. Rick Answer:** Newsman, author, and host of *The Whistler* on YouTube and Spotify. Addressed the board regarding facility funding reserves, the necessity of building corporations for stadium reconstruction, questions surrounding the partnership agreement with the faith-based private alternative program ("The Crossing"), taxpayer costs, and community inquiries regarding access restrictions at a grade school graduation and administrative staff shifts at South View. (*Note: Additional specific comments by Mr. Answer during the public hearings on bond leasing and appropriations are documented under Section 4*).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Dr. K highlighted student spotlights (including the Whiteley Community Council's HBCU trip to Washington D.C. led by Ken Hudson), state visits by Senator Scott Alexander, extensive summer professional development programs, athletic achievements (such as national high jumper and coach Charity Griffith), marching band activities, and success with IREAD-3 assessments and newcomer programs.
- Upcoming schedule notes include budget presentations in August and continued capital improvement hearings.

- **Adjournment:** The regular meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second.

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